

Pythagoras at the Blacksmith's Shop!

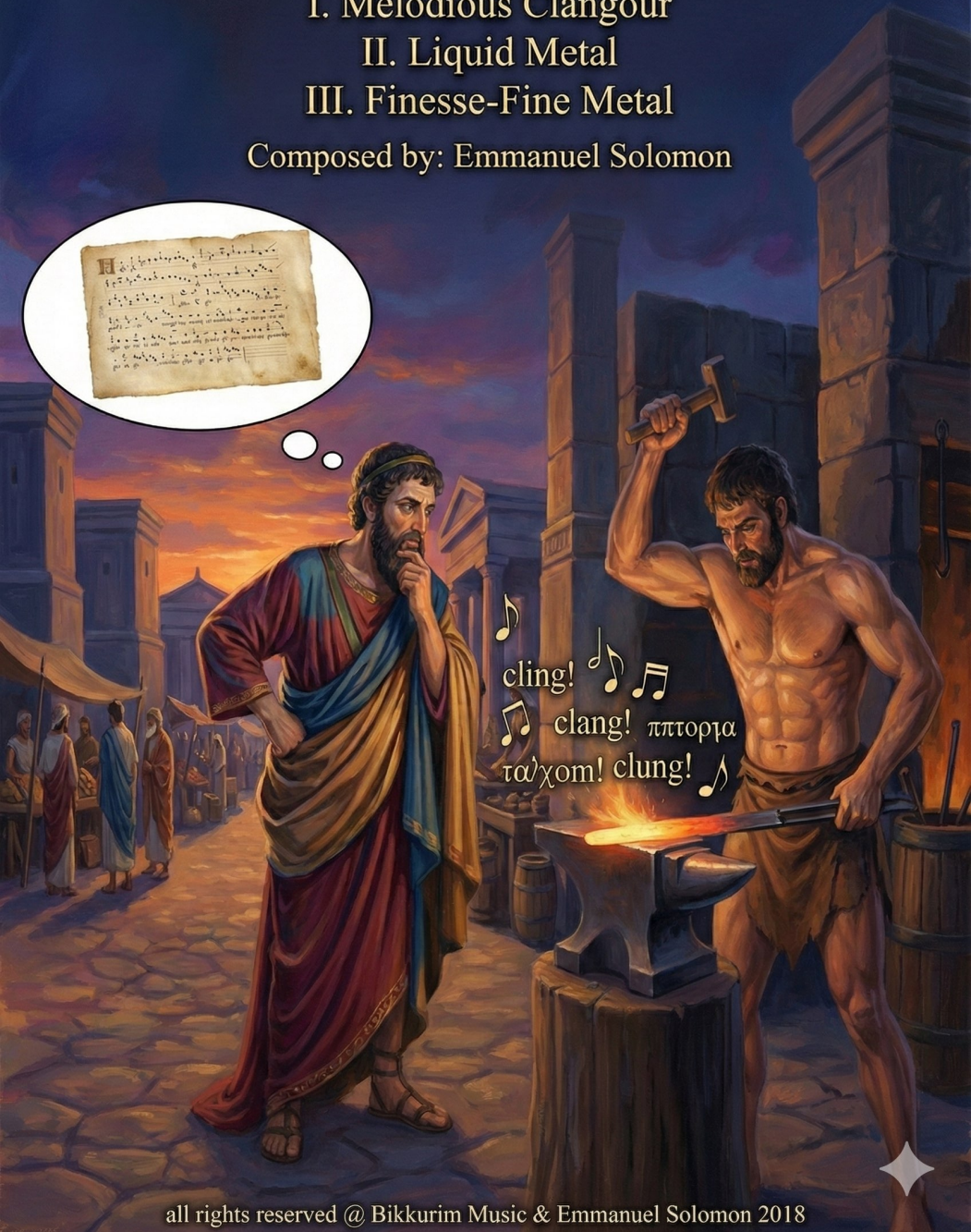
Unaccompanied Flute Solos [Vignettes]

I. Melodious Clangour

II. Liquid Metal

III. Finesse-Fine Metal

Composed by: Emmanuel Solomon



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UNACCOMPANIED FLUTE SOLOS

By

EMMANUEL SOLOMON

Melodious Clangour

Liquid Metal

Finesse-Fine Metal

Composed Nov. 2018.

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This is an unaccompanied 12-tones solo written for the Flute. It is in 3 short movements called vignettes:

- *Melodic Clangour*
- *Liquid metal*
- *Finesse-Fine metal*

The whole work narrates the story of the famous Greek philosopher, Pythagoras, who was attracted by the clanging sound of metals from a Blacksmith's shop. Curious to know why the sounds varied in pitches, he visited the shop.

Therefore, in this atonal work, I decided to represent these 'unorganised' sounds or pitches that Pythagoras heard using the 12-tones rows. He observes how a metal is being made.

Melodious Clangour depicts the sound of the metals that are being beaten with mallets by the Blacksmith and his apprentice. All these metals clanging would create different pitches because of their different densities and properties. The first three group of notes and the second three group of the opening row(P5) are melodic sequence of each other and they represent the harmonious sounds of the clanging metals even though they sound cacophonic, there seems to be a sense of coherence. The use of slurred triplets(subset) that recurs all over the work are representation of bellows blowing air into the fire to heat up the metals to liquify

them. The slurred triplets accompany the notes of any row (the clanging sounds of metals).

Liquid Metal should be performed with so much grace and fluidity because it is a representation of the heated metals that are being melted and poured into moulders to take the shape of whatever tool the Blacksmith was making. The reiteration of the C (common/pivot tone) at the end of the piece represents the gradual solidification of the metal.

Finesse-Fine metal, the final movement of this work, represents the craftiness of the Blacksmith to beat the solid metal into fine metal and decorate it with ornaments to make it appealing to the eyes of a buyer. This ornamentation is heard and depicted with a mordent, rubato and a graciously gentle dying away trill in to a rallentando (slow tempo) from the upbeat of bar 25 till the end of the movement.

Throughout the work, row P5 has been reinstated to maintain coherence and unification of the 3 movements. The subset F, B, C served as the invariance that exist between rows and it is heard throughout the work. D and C pivot tones used to transit from one row to another. The dynamics and articulation have been carefully placed throughout the music to paint the idea of this work and they should be strictly observed.

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1. Melodious Clangour

Emmanuel Solomon

Flute

$\text{♩} = 120$

legato

f *expressivo*

3

$\text{♩} = 80$

p *fp*

6

Fl.

3

sf

simile

3

3

3

3

3

3

8

Fl.

3

3

3

3

3

p *f* *p* *f*

$\text{♩} = 60$

3

13

Fl.

$\text{♩} = 80$

rubato

3

3

3

$\text{♩} = 60$

18

Fl.

gliss.

p *f* *p* *ff*

3

3

3

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11. Liquid Metal

Emmanuel Solomon

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in 3/4 time. It is divided into three systems of staves.

Staff 1 (Measures 1-7): Starts with a tempo marking of $\text{♩} = 70$ and a dynamic of *f* with the instruction *legato*. The melody features a long slur spanning measures 1 through 7. Measure 7 has a tempo change to $\text{♩} = 80$. Measures 6 and 7 contain triplets of eighth notes.

Staff 2 (Measures 8-10): Measure 8 begins with a triplet of eighth notes. Measure 9 has a tempo marking of $\text{♩} = 100$ and a dynamic of *p*. Measure 10 has a tempo marking of $\text{♩} = 70$ and a dynamic of *cresc.* (crescendo). The staff ends with a five-measure rest.

Staff 3 (Measures 11-14): Measure 11 has a five-measure rest. Measure 12 has a tempo marking of $\text{♩} = 100$ and a dynamic of *ff*. Measure 13 has a dynamic of *p*. Measure 14 has a dynamic of *f*. The staff concludes with a final *ff* dynamic and a fermata over the last note.

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III. Finesse-Fine metal

Emmanuel Solomon

$\text{♩} = 60$ Delicately

$\text{♩} = 90$

$\text{♩} = 160$

$\text{♩} = 90$

$\text{♩} = 120$

29 rall.

f *fp* *f* *p* *mf*

f

p *f* *p* *mp*

p *p* *f*

ppp